

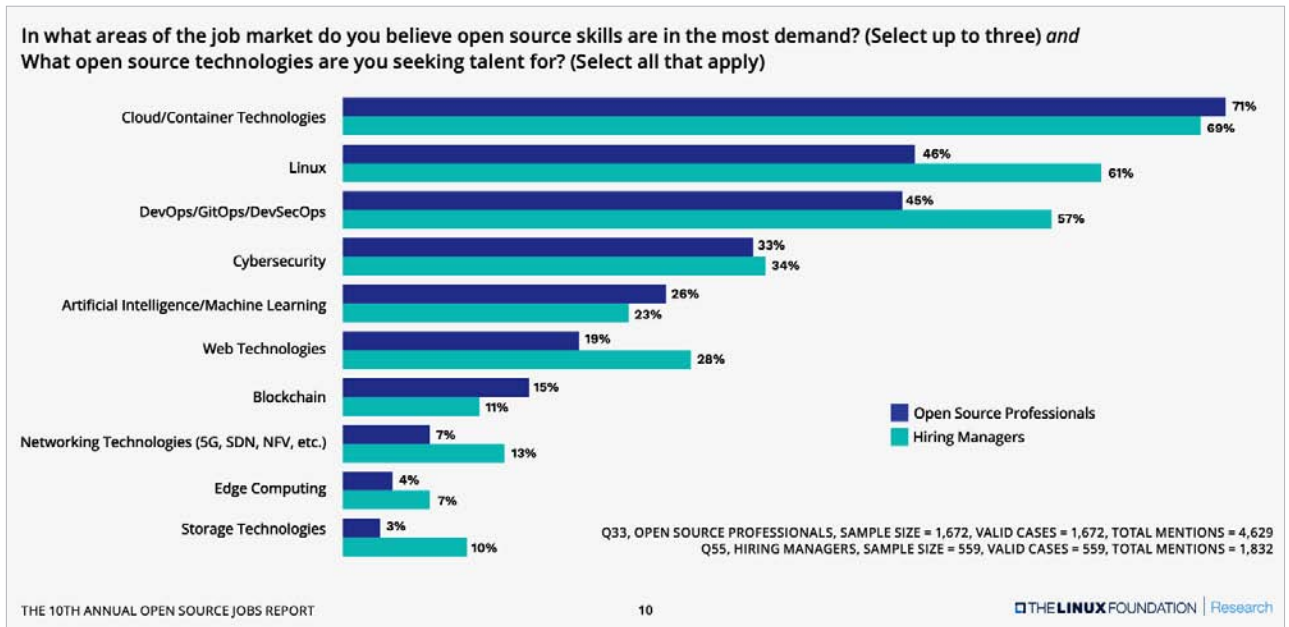


Figure 1: Technologies where open source skills are in demand

Once you have mastered these subjects, you are ready to learn container and cloud native technologies. As these cover many topics, I would like to specifically call out the topics you must learn in order to become a cloud native engineer:

- Container runtimes like *containerd*, Docker
- Kubernetes
- Helm
- Working knowledge of any public cloud (Azure, AWS or Google Cloud)
- Prometheus
- OpenTelemetry
- Overview of service mesh

Every other topic after this is an add-on, to be learnt on a need basis.

Now let us take a look at what are the different ways in which you can learn these subjects.

YouTube

Almost everyone goes to YouTube first to learn about any new topic. But this comes with its own challenges:

- A lot to choose from, which is very confusing.
- There is no defined path, and one can move in endless cycles to watch some random videos.
- Content is not up-to-date.
- There is no mentor or instructor available to guide.
- There are no hands-on labs available to practice while watching the videos.

In my opinion YouTube is not for serious learners. One can get a very good overview of a subject, which may be sufficient in a few cases.

Self-paced online training

Self-paced online training gives you the flexibility to go over the content anytime you wish to. Most such online courses are only video based but some of them now come with an in-built lab environment. So choose the latter, whenever possible.

When you start looking for courses, I would suggest exploring official free training, if available. CNCF has an introductory course on Kubernetes on Edx called 'Introduction to Kubernetes' (<https://www.edx.org/course/introduction-to-kubernetes>). Just for your information, I authored its initial version.

Once you have completed the official free courses, you can explore other courses from different online training websites, which offer some great content (refer to the box).

List of online resources for learning cloud native technologies

- <https://training.linuxfoundation.org>
- <https://cloudyuga.guru>
- <https://kodekloud.com>
- <https://www.pluralsight.com>
- <https://cloudacademy.com>
- <https://learnk8s.io/academy>
- <https://www.udemy.com>

Self-paced mode of learning requires a lot of internal motivation and discipline to finish the courses, as learners are on their own. Active participation in local community events like meetups, workshops and becoming a part of the online communities is highly advisable in case you are pursuing this kind of training.

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